VRITIMES

press release 101

anatomy of a press release editors actually publish

not the ones they bin



Raise It With Press Release

swipe →

01

the headline is news, not a slogan

Subject + action + impact. Aim for 10–14 words with a number or a place name.

example

× "Innovation Without Limits"

✓ "Brisbane Logistics Start-up Opens 4 Regional Queensland Hubs, Cuts Delivery to One Day"

02

the lead answers 5w1h in two sentences

Editors decide in seconds. If paragraph one doesn't say **what, who, when, where and why now**, that is where reading stops.

03

one quote with an actual opinion

A quote is not the place for "we are thrilled". Give a point of view, a number or a plan a reporter can lift.

example

× "We are thrilled to announce this milestone."
✓ "Next-day delivery shouldn't stop at the city limits. Regional Queensland is where we start."

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72%

of journalists call press releases the most useful resource from pr teams

Press releases aren't dead. Releases a newsroom can't use straight away are.

Source: Cision, State of the Media 2025

a body that is ready to use

- Inverted pyramid: the most important fact first
- Data with a comparison (up from what, to what?)
- 1–2 high-res photos with captions
- A media contact who actually picks up

05

the boilerplate: 3 sentences everyone underrates

Who you are, since when, how big, where, and your official link. Write it once, refresh it every quarter. Journalists copy it as is.

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check these 3 before you hit send

1. Headline: subject, action and a number?
2. Lead: 5W1H done in two sentences?
3. Quote: an opinion or a data point?

Source:
· Cision, State of the Media 2025